Capstone Brief

Africa is one of the world's great storytelling continents, with a wealth of narratives carried in its languages, music, film, journalism, literature, games, and everyday voices. Yet too often these stories are told about Africa rather than by it, flattened into a single narrative, lost in translation, or crowded out by content made elsewhere. African storytellers face real barriers to reaching audiences. The richness of local voices, in dozens of languages and forms, remains underserved by the tools and platforms shaping how stories get made and shared. At the same time, AI is transforming how stories are created, discovered, and distributed, with the power either to amplify African voices or to drown them out.

For this hackathon, in partnership between OpenAI and Andela, we are asking you to use AI software development tools to build people-centric technology that helps Africans tell their own stories, in their own voices, to the audiences who want to hear them. Build tools that put African storytellers at the centre and make authentic African narratives easier to create, discover, and own.

Choose from four submission tracks:

Tracks	About
Voices & Languages	Technology that helps African stories be told and understood across the continent's many languages. Focus on practical use cases like translating and narrating stories in local and underserved languages, preserving the voice and nuance of the original, or helping storytellers reach audiences who speak differently from them, so that language is a bridge rather than a barrier.

Discovery & Audience	Build tools that help African stories find the people who want them. This could include powering new formats and immersive experiences that help African narratives compete for attention alongside global content.
Creation & Craft	Design tools that empower African storytellers, writers, filmmakers, journalists, animators, musicians, and game makers to create and produce. Prioritise tools that extend the craft rather than replace it, that lower the cost and complexity of production, and that help creators turn ideas into finished, shareable work while keeping the human author at the centre.
Truth, Authorship & Ownership	Build tools that protect authentic representation and the rights of the people whose stories are being told. This could include countering misinformation, verifying sources or giving creators and communities control over how their stories are used and monetised, so that African narratives are honoured rather than exploited.

Project Scope

Using AI software development tools, build a solution that responds to a real challenge in creating, sharing, discovering, or protecting African stories, within one or more of the tracks above. This is intentionally broad to give you room to explore the needs of different storytellers, communities, languages, and creative forms, and to develop an original approach.

Your project should do more than present a story. It should help people and communities tell, reach, or own their stories in a lasting way.

Tip: This is an invention sprint, not a product launch. You are not expected to build production-ready software. You are expected to use AI software development tools to create a working proof of concept that demonstrates your idea is useful, viable, and worth developing further. Please refrain from using AI to generate your capstone idea.